

August 12, 2026

Medicare (Palmetto GBA, JM MAC)
Provider Appeals Department

RE: Formal Appeal of Claim Denial — Loria Jenkins (MRN MUSC8620970), Claim MUSC-20260618-E7DE-1

Patient	Loria Jenkins (DOB 1937-07-15)
MRN	MUSC8620970
Member ID / Group	MED286101916 / GRP-47725
Claim number	MUSC-20260618-E7DE-1
Date of service	2026-06-18
Procedure billed	CPT 99223 — Initial hospital care, high complexity
Primary diagnosis	E66.9 — Obesity, unspecified
Denied amount	\$2,668.39
Denial code	CARC 18 / RARC N522 — Exact duplicate claim/service.
Appeal deadline	2026-11-01

Dear Appeals Review Committee:

SUMMARY OF APPEAL

MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center submits this first-level redetermination request to Palmetto GBA, J15 MAC, on behalf of patient Loria Jenkins (MRN: MUSC8620970, Member ID: MED286101916) regarding Claim ID MUSC-20260618-E7DE-1, with a date of service of June 18, 2026. The claim was submitted on June 22, 2026, for CPT code 99223 (initial hospital care, high complexity) rendered by Dr. Priya N. Raghavan, MD (NPI 1669504132) at MUSC Health East Cooper Medical Center, Place of Service 21. The total billed amount was \$2,668.39, which was denied in full on July 4, 2026. This redetermination is submitted within the 120-day filing window, prior to the appeal deadline of November 1, 2026.

CLINICAL BACKGROUND

Ms. Jenkins is an 89-year-old female patient with a documented history of chronic congestive heart failure (I25.10), hyperlipidemia (E78.5), and prediabetes (E11.9), among other active conditions. She presented for an inpatient admission on June 18, 2026, with a primary diagnosis of obesity, unspecified (E66.9). Dr. Raghavan performed and documented an initial inpatient hospital care evaluation of high complexity, consistent with the patient's significant comorbidity burden. The claim was submitted under revenue code 0510 with a single unit of CPT 99223, which appropriately reflects the complexity of the evaluation required for this patient.

BASIS FOR APPEAL

Palmetto GBA denied this claim citing CARC 18 ("Exact duplicate claim/service") and RARC N522 ("Duplicate of a claim processed or in process as a crossover/coordination of benefits claim"), with the payer remark stating: "Claim appears to duplicate a previously adjudicated claim." MUSC Health respectfully disputes this determination.

CPT code 99223 represents an initial hospital care service, by definition billable only once per admission per admitting or co-admitting physician. MUSC Health's records confirm that Claim MUSC-20260618-E7DE-1 represents the sole submission of this service by Dr. Raghavan for Ms. Jenkins's June 18, 2026 inpatient encounter. No prior claim for this same CPT code, provider, date of service, and patient combination was submitted by MUSC Health that would constitute a true duplicate. The denial under CARC 18 and RARC N522 therefore does not reflect the actual billing history for this encounter.

Furthermore, RARC N522 references a crossover or coordination of benefits scenario. Medicare is the primary payer for Ms. Jenkins under a coverage period running from January 1, 2024, through December 31, 2026. No secondary payer coordination issue has been identified that would justify withholding payment on this basis. If Palmetto GBA has identified a specific previously adjudicated claim number that it believes duplicates this submission, MUSC Health respectfully requests that information be provided so any discrepancy can be promptly investigated and resolved.

MUSC Health has reviewed its internal claim submission records and confirmed that this claim was submitted once, on June 22, 2026, four days after the date of service, well within timely filing requirements. The services billed are supported by the medical record, the patient's documented comorbidities, and the complexity of care required during this inpatient encounter.

REQUESTED ACTION

MUSC Health respectfully requests that Palmetto GBA conduct a full redetermination of Claim MUSC-20260618-E7DE-1, reverse the duplicate denial issued under CARC 18 and RARC N522, and reprocess the claim for payment of the allowed amount of \$1,771.96. Should Palmetto GBA require additional documentation, including the medical record for the June 18, 2026 encounter, the original claim submission confirmation, or a claim history report demonstrating the absence of a prior submission, MUSC Health will provide those materials promptly upon request.

Respectfully submitted,

Angela R. Whitfield, RN, BSN, CPC

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Enclosures

- Remittance advice / explanation of payment
- Itemized claim detail (UB-04 / CMS-1500)
- Relevant clinical documentation from the medical record